URGENT PUBLIC-SOURCE REVIEW

Tirana: force and injuries

13 October 2026 · A concise visual record for human-rights and diplomatic recipients. The locations below are Tirana unless a publisher identifies a more precise site; posting time is not capture time.

What is established from the cited coverage
Police used tear gas and water cannon during a student-led protest; photographs and video show police physically moving and restraining people. A man interviewed at the Trauma Hospital reported a serious leg injury and alleged police assault. Some participants threw stones and lit fires.

01 · 13 OCT



Cloud or spray beside police line

The frame shows a dense cloud or spray. Vizion Plus identifies police use of gas and water in its report; the still alone cannot identify the substance.

VIZION PLUS · VIDEO [OPEN]

02 · 13 OCT



Visible injury amid police presence

Red staining is visible on a person's face. The photograph does not establish how it occurred. Upper facial detail is blurred for protection.

NEWS24 / BALKANWEB · PHOTO [OPEN]

IMMEDIATE REQUEST

Protect people still on the streets and in custody; preserve all original footage, police orders, deployment logs, custody records and medical documentation; investigate specific force incidents independently.

Reuters contemporaneous account [OPEN]

Albanian Helsinki Committee statement [OPEN]

Euronews Albania hospital interview [OPEN]

Method. This brief separates what is visible, what a named source reports and what remains unverified. Media images are reproduced as small, credited evidential thumbnails; click each credit for its publication. Identity blur is disclosed above.

VISUAL RECORD

Police contact and restraint

Selected News24/BalkanWeb stills published 13 October. These are separate frames, not a proved sequence. Number labels replace intrusive arrows; captions identify only what each frame supports.



Baton at close range

An officer holds a baton across a blue-shirted man's torso amid a physical confrontation. The still does not by itself show a strike.

NEWS24 / BALKANWEB · PHOTO [OPEN]



Person down near officers

A blue-shirted man is on the ground as officers move nearby. The original video and accounts are needed to establish how he fell.

NEWS24 / BALKANWEB · PHOTO [OPEN]



Person held by several officers

Several uniformed officers are visibly restraining a person. Necessity, duration and force applied require the full recording.

NEWS24 / BALKANWEB · PHOTO [OPEN]



Person on ground during arrest

Officers are close to a person on the pavement. The frame raises a safeguarding question but does not show the preceding conduct.

NEWS24 / BALKANWEB · PHOTO [OPEN]

CROSS-SOURCE RECORD

What the reports add

Links below open the original reporting or video. The record is sufficient for urgent protective action and prompt preservation of evidence; it is not a substitute for interviewing witnesses or examining originals.

A Gas and water cannon

Reuters reports both tear gas and water cannon at the Education Ministry. Vizion Plus and Panorama publish contemporaneous video and describe gas/water use. ADCN has witness accounts of irritating water; its composition remains untested.

Reuters [OPEN] **Vizion Plus [OPEN]** **Panorama video [OPEN]**

B Reported serious leg injury

Euronews Albania interviewed the injured man at the Trauma Hospital. He said he was a bystander and alleged police caused his injury. Vizion Plus reports that police suspended four officers and a station commander pending investigation.

Hospital interview [OPEN] **Suspension report [OPEN]**

C Wider injuries and detentions

Helsinki Committee observers report injuries to protesters, police and journalists. News24 reports more than 40 people taken by police. Panorama describes footage of a woman pulled from a café where she sought refuge from gas and water.

Helsinki Committee [OPEN] **News24 [OPEN]** **Panorama video [OPEN]**

D Stones, fire and public safety

Reuters and Albanian outlets report thrown objects, property damage and fires by some participants. Those acts require individual investigation. They do not erase the assembly rights or safety of every other person present.

Reuters [OPEN] **MCN TV [OPEN]** **News24 photos [OPEN]**

NOT VERIFIED

The rumour that a minor died, a claim that the injured man is in a coma, the precise diagnosis, and the chemical composition of water are not established here. A2 News quoted the Trauma Hospital emergency chief saying that no patient had died or been intubated at the time of his statement.

A2 hospital statement [OPEN]

ACTION AND VERIFICATION

Preserve, protect, investigate

A recipient can act now while individual allegations are tested. Each line names a concrete record or safeguard that would make the record more reliable.

01

Protect people

Ensure medical care and lawyer access for injured and detained people; keep bystanders, journalists and peaceful participants safe.

02

Preserve originals

Secure police body-camera/CCTV files, radio and command logs, use-of-force forms, custody records, medical records, and the unedited publisher footage.

03

Test each incident

Establish identities privately, exact location/time, the officer unit, sequence before and after a frame, injury mechanism and independent witness accounts.

04

Disclose agents

Identify tear-gas munitions and the water-cannon mixture, concentrations, operational orders and medical guidance. ADCN expects an expert report on reported irritation.

05

Report publicly

Publish a prompt, impartial account with remedies and disciplinary or criminal referrals where evidence supports them.

SOURCE INDEX

Reuters [OPEN] **News24/BalkanWeb [OPEN]** **Vizion Plus [OPEN]** **Panorama gas video [OPEN]**

Panorama restraint video [OPEN] **Euronews Albania [OPEN]** **A2 News [OPEN]** **Helsinki Committee [OPEN]**

MCN TV [OPEN] **AP/TASR image [OPEN]** **European Democrats [OPEN]**

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